

Full Name

Esber S. Saba, Ph.D.

Affiliation

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Brief Profile

Dr. Esber S. Saba is an Assistant Professor in the Department of Experimental Pathology, Immunology and Microbiology at the American University of Beirut. His research focuses on bacteriophage biology, phage engineering, antimicrobial resistance, and host–phage immune interactions. He leads projects on therapeutic phage development, phage host-range prediction using machine learning approaches, and engineered phage platforms for diagnostics and antimicrobial applications.

Dr. Saba is also actively involved in translational neuroimmunology research, particularly in biomarker discovery and immune profiling in multiple sclerosis. His work integrates microbiology, immunology, genomics, and advanced data analysis to develop next-generation antimicrobial and diagnostic strategies.

Full Name

May Mrad, Ph.D.

Affiliation

Research Associate
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Brief Profile

Dr. May Mrad is a research associate in translational science and multidisciplinary collaboration. Her work focuses on the molecular and immunological mechanisms of inflammation and neuroimmunological disorders, especially multiple sclerosis, with a particular interest in the role of exosomes in disease pathogenesis and their clinical applications.

Full name

Layane El-Nakib

Affiliation

Research assistant, Department of Experimental Pathology, Immunology and Microbiology, Faculty of Medicine, American University of Beirut. Beirut, Lebanon.

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Brief profile

Layane Nakib holds a Bachelor's degree in Biology and a Master's degree in Genomics and Health. She is involved in blood processing and biobanking activities related to multiple sclerosis research. She also works in translational neuroimmunology research, with a current focus on the molecular and immunological mechanisms of inflammation in multiple sclerosis, and a particular interest in the characterization of exosomes and their relevance to biomarker discovery.

Full name

Vera Dermesrobian

Affiliation

Department of Microbiology, Immunology and Transplantation, KU Leuven Flow and Mass Cytometry Facility, KU Leuven, Leuven, 3000, Belgium

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Brief profile

Vera Dermesrobian is the coordinator of the Flow and Mass Cytometry Core Facility at KU Leuven, where she oversees daily operations, strategic development, and technological innovation. With a background in biochemistry and biotechnology, she specializes in conventional, spectral, and mass cytometry, with extensive hands-on experience across different platforms. She supports researchers through training, troubleshooting, workflow optimization, and the implementation of robust, reproducible cytometry solutions.

Full Name

Joseph Abboud, M.D.

Affiliation

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Brief profile

Dr. Abboud is a physician-scientist with dedicated experience in multiple sclerosis clinical research and data analytics at a tertiary MS center.

Full Name

Samia J Khoury, MD

Affiliation

About Haidar Neuroscience Institute and Nehme and Therese Tohme Multiple Sclerosis Center, American University of Beirut

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Brief Profile

Dr. Samia Khoury is the Director of the Abu Haidar Neuroscience Institute and Director of Nehme and Therese Tohme Multiple Sclerosis Center at AUBMC, the first MS (Multiple Sclerosis) center in the region, and Director of the research lab specialized in MS and immunology. She is a professor of neurology and Immunology at the American University of Beirut. In 2007, Dr. Khoury was awarded the prestigious Kuwait Prize for Sciences by the Kuwait Foundation for the Advancement of Sciences for her work in immunology. She is the recipient of the King Salman prize for disability research in 2022 and the Mustafa Prize for Life and Medical Science and Technology in 2023. She has published over 300 scholarly articles, reviews, and book chapters.